

True Crime Book Club

Monthly discussion notes and reading list

Discussion notes for the true crime nonfiction book club, one title a month, read through a family law lens.

Format

The club reads one nonfiction title each month and meets to discuss it. The conversation leans on the criminal justice system as a structure, viewed with the educated skepticism that family law work tends to build. Selections and prompts are posted ahead of each meeting.

This month's themes

- Investigative procedure and how a case is built.
- Evidence handling and the chain of custody.
- The limits of memory and eyewitness testimony.

Discussion questions

No.	Question
1	Where did the chain of custody hold, and where did it slip?
2	How would family court treat the same testimony?
3	What did the system get right that rarely gets credit?
4	Which detail would change the outcome if it had surfaced earlier?

On the shelf

Title	Author	Status
The Whistler	John Grisham	Read
Look Again	Lisa Scottoline	Reading
The Prince of Tides	Pat Conroy	Read
Where the Crawdads Sing	Delia Owens	Read

How the club runs

The group meets once a month to talk through the title. One reading selection and a short set of prompts go out at the start of the month, and the discussion stays grounded in how the justice system actually works rather than in the drama of a single case. Newcomers are welcome any month, with no need to have read the back catalog.

- One title a month, nonfiction, true crime leaning.
- Selections and prompts posted at the start of each month.
- Discussion read through a family law lens, with educated skepticism.
- Hosting rotates, and the next pick is set by the group.

Coming up

Month	Theme to explore
This month	Investigative procedure and chain of custody
Next month	Memory, testimony, and what holds up in court
The month after	Sentencing, outcomes, and second chances

Why the family law lens

Years of family law work change how a true story reads. The questions that surface are less about who did it and more about how the system handled the people caught in it, where the process held, and where it failed the family at the center. That lens keeps the discussion grounded and honest, even when the case is grim.

- Read for the process, not the spectacle.
- Notice where a family was helped or harmed by the system.
- Bring one question and one doubt to every meeting.

Next month's pick goes out with the discussion prompts at the start of the month.